

Please check the examination details below before entering your candidate information

Candidate surname	Other names
Centre Number	Candidate Number

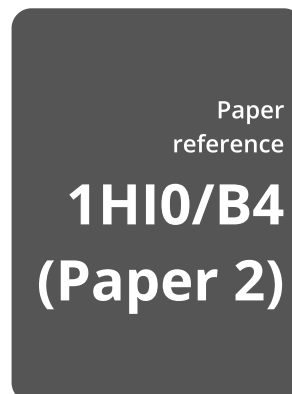
Pearson Edexcel GCSE (9-1)

Thursday 4 June 2026

Morning (Time: 1 hour 50 minutes -
total time for **both** booklets)

History

**BOOKLET B4: Early Elizabethan England,
1558-88**



You must have:

The corresponding booklet P.

Total Marks

Instructions

- Use **black** ink or ball-point pen.
- **Fill in the boxes** at the top of this page with your name, centre number and candidate number.
- There are two booklets in this question paper. **This is booklet B.**
- Answer questions 1(a), 1(b), 2 and **either 3 or 4** in this booklet.
- Check you have the corresponding booklet P.
- Answer the questions in the spaces provided
- *there may be more space than you need.*

Information

- The total mark for this booklet is 32.

- The total time for **both** booklets is 1 hour 50 minutes.
- The marks for **each** question are shown in brackets
- use this as a guide as to how much time to spend on each question.
- **Do not forget to complete booklet P.**

Advice

- Read each question carefully before you start to answer it.
- Try to divide your time equally between each booklet of the question paper.
- Check your answers if you have time at the end.

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Early Elizabethan England, 1558-88

Answer Question 1(a), Question 1(b), Question 2 and EITHER Question 3 OR Question 4.

- 1** (a) Describe one characteristic of poverty in early Elizabethan England. (2)

- (b) Describe one characteristic of the English attempts to colonise Virginia. (2)

(Total for Question 1 = 4 marks)

- 2 Explain why the Northern Earls' Rebellion (1569-70) posed a significant danger to Elizabeth I. (12)

You **may** use the following in your answer:

- Mary, Queen of Scots
- Anglo-Spanish relations

*You **must** also use information of your own.*

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(Total for Question 2 = 12 marks)
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Answer EITHER Question 3 OR Question 4.

EITHER

- 3** "Economic difficulties were the most significant challenge Elizabeth faced upon her accession in 1558."

How far do you agree? Explain your answer.

*You **may** use the following in your answer:*

- The royal debt
- Elizabeth's claim to the throne

*You **must** also use information of your own.*

(Total for Question 3 = 16 marks)

OR

- 4** "Spanish strategic errors were the primary cause of England's triumph over the Armada."

How far do you agree? Explain your answer.

*You **may** use the following in your answer:*

- The command of the Duke of Medina Sidonia
- The deployment of fireships

*You **must** also use information of your own.*

(Total for Question 4 = 16 marks)

Chosen question number: Question 3 ☐ Question 4 ☐

Page 8 of 13

This image shows a full page of a document template designed for handwritten notes or essays. It features approximately 28 evenly spaced, thin grey horizontal lines extending across the entire width of the page. The margins are consistent on all sides, providing ample space for writing. There are no vertical lines, headers, footers, or other markings present on the page.

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TOTAL FOR BOOKLET B = 32 MARKS

PLEASE ENSURE YOU ALSO COMPLETE BOOKLET P.

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